

Are you game?

DIGIT
COMMUNITY

We have just concluded the first of the "Are you game?" workshops in Delhi and believe us it was a Sunday well spent. What started out to be a small 30 minute session turned into a two hour discussion on computer hardware, what are the good brands to purchase keeping in mind the after-sales support, performance etc., what console is better (not telling you the answer) which are the good games, over-clocking your machine and LAN parties. We also had a discussion on the page 3 circuit of gaming... yes there does exist one. Check out some snaps of the event, and pre-register yourself for the next one that happens in your city. **Details on page 36!**



tech art

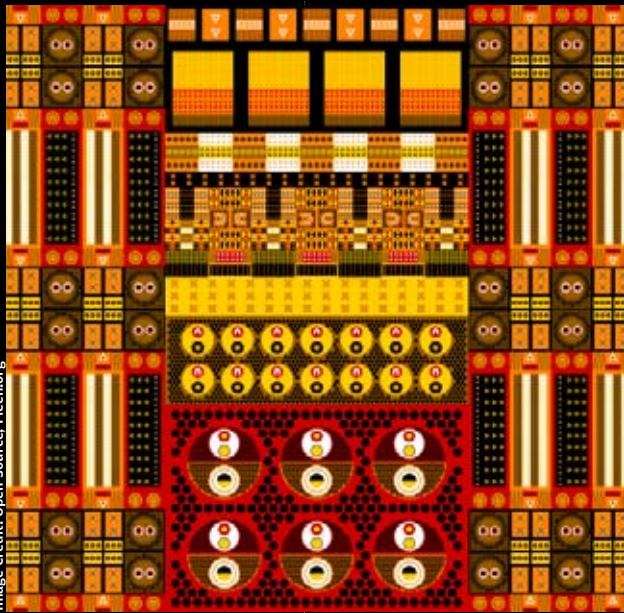


Image Credit: Open Source, Fleen.org

Algorithmic artists, or algotists use computer code to generate works of art. The role of the artist is to write the code necessary to draw the piece of work. Although code can be written in a very specific manner, so that an artist can get exactly what he wants, often the artist allows some calculations on the machine side, and allows for pseudorandom values to influence the work. In this way, a number of different pieces of work can be generated using the same algorithm. Small tweaks and changes in the algorithm will draw largely different kinds of artwork. For algorithms and artwork, head over to <http://fleen.org>.

Mars first imaged using crayons

HISTORY



What if we were to tell you that the first images of Mars were made by crayons. Humans and their impatience will never cease to amaze us. The first image was taken by the spacecraft Mariner 4 on July 15, 1965. Well it actually took a total of 21 images, using a television camera, alternating between red and green filters and saved on a tape.

The images started transmitting to the Jet Propulsion Laboratory (JPL) after 8.5 hours due to signal loss as Mariner 4 actually going around the planet. Finally the image was being sent to JPL as a stream of 8-bit numbers. This transmission lasted until August 13. The image was originally supposed to be processed by the lab's imager, but as we mentioned, people at JPL were just too eager to see what Mars looked like.

So what was the next step? Well they decided to print the numbers and allocated brightness and different pastel colours to strips of the paper. The end result was the first ever image taken by Mars in crayons.

For those who came in late

Muddled by so many terms used in the mag? Here's your short guide to the tech lingo

Arcade: Gameplay that is unrealistic and designed for having fun only.

Build: A version of a software built for a specific purpose. The licensed software in the DVD for example, are *builds* for Digit.

FPS: A first person shooter, a type of game in which you play from the point of view of a person, with a gun.

CES: Consumer Electronics Show, an annual exhibition where tech companies showcase their latest gadgets.

Netbook: A type of laptop that is used for simple tasks such as sending e-mails and writing documents, that are not demanding on the machine's resources.

Cloud: The cloud is an online pool of data. All the clouds together can be called the cloud, but an organisation or even an individual, can have a cloud of their own.